What Is Contemporary Art?

Today's goals
Complete any 3 learning items - 3/3
Complete 3 readings - 3/3
Watch a video

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Borders & Transit
Introduction to Module 3 — Reading • 10 min
In the studio with Rael San Fratello | Transforming the wall — Video • 5 min
Bouchra Khalili on The Mapping Journey Project, 2008–11 — Video • 3 min
Crossing borders — Reading • 10 min
Mateo López on Travel without Movement, 2008–10 — Video • 2 min

Place
Claiming space — Reading • 10 min
Shellyne Rodriguez on Martin Wong, Stanton near Forsyth Street, 1983 — Video • 1 min
Changing states — Reading • 10 min
IRWIN on NSK Garda, 2002 — Video • 1 min
Sky Hopinka on Jáaji Approx., 2015 — Reading • 10 min
Amanda Williams on Color(ed) Theory Suite, 2014–16 — Video • 2 min
Portfolio: Teresa Margolles, Pista de baile (Dance Floor), 2016 — Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
Memory Check — Practice Assignment • Grade: 90%
Reflect on Territories & Transit — Dialogue • 15 min
Mid-course survey — Reading • 5 min
Optional Readings & Resources — Reading • 10 min

Module 4
Materials & Making

What Is It Made Of?
Introduction to Module 4 — Reading • 10 min
At the Museum with Sheila Hicks | Form, Texture, Color — Video • 4 min
Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009 — Video • 1 min
Film, vinyl, and ultrasonic gel — Reading • 10 min
Sheela Gowda on Of All People, 2011 — Video • 3 min
3-D printed architecture with Rael San Fratello — Video • 4 min

How Is It Made?
How is contemporary art made? — Reading • 10 min
Lady Pink on Trust visions that don't feature buckets of blood, 1983–84 — Video • 2 min
Glenn Ligon on White #19, 1994 — Video • 1 min
Amy Sillman on making and unmaking painting — Video • 1 min
Building, painting, printing — Reading • 10 min
Luther Price, Sorry, 2005–12 — Reading • 10 min

Who Makes It?
Labor and work in contemporary art — Reading • 10 min
Interview with Revital Cohen & Tuur Van Balen on 75 Watt, 2013 — Reading • 10 min
Anne Teresa De Keersmaeker, Work/Travail/Arbeid, 2017 — Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
Memory Check — Practice Assignment
Reflect on Module 4 Insights — Dialogue • 15 min
Optional Readings & Resources — Reading • 10 min

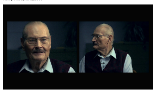
Module 5
Agency

Module 6
Power

Film, vinyl, and ultrasonic gel

0:11 / 4:23 1x

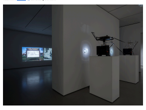
Kerry Tribe, *H.M.*, 2009



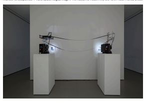
Kerry Tribe. H.M. 2009. 16mm film (color, sound; 18:30 min.), two 16mm film projectors, custom looper. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 Kerry Tribe

Kerry Tribe has said that for new projects she "usually starts with a simultaneous notion of some formal structure as a kind of container for…the 'content'…." For *H.M.*, she chose 16mm film as the optimal material to convey the true story of a man named Henry Molaison (dubbed "Patient H.M." in medical literature) who became severely memory impaired after undergoing a lobotomy. Like memory, film is unstable and degrades over time.

Tribe's presentation of *H.M.* further evokes Molaison's state. She loops the filmstrip through two side-by-side projectors, producing a double projection. One projector runs 20 seconds behind the other such that its delayed projection reads as an imprint, or memory, of the projection it trails. The timing of this delay is intentional: the lobotomy obliterated Molaison's long-term memory, but his short-term memory remained intact at 20 seconds of retention. [Watch](#) **an excerpt of *H.M.***



Kerry Tribe. H.M. 2009. 16mm film (color, sound; 18:30 min.), two 16mm film projectors, custom looper. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 Kerry Tribe. Installation view, *Images of an Infinite Film*, The Museum of Modern Art, New York, September 7–March 2, 2014. Digital image © The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Photo: Thomas Griesel



Kerry Tribe. H.M. 2009. 16mm film (color, sound; 18:30 min.), two 16mm film projectors, custom looper. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 Kerry Tribe. Installation view, *Images of an Infinite Film*, The Museum of Modern Art, New York, September 7–March 2, 2014. Digital image © The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Photo: Thomas Griesel

Rodney McMillian, *Succulent*, 2010

Rodney McMillian. *Succulent*. 2010. Vinyl and thread, 14' × 27' 6" (426.7 × 838.2 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of The Friends of Education of The Museum of Modern Art, and given in memory of M.D.S.B. by his wife (by exchange), and Richard D. Brixey Bequest (by exchange)

Rodney McMillian made *Succulent* out of a massive sheet of vinyl. In an interview in MoMA Magazine, he describes his attraction to this material.

"I think my interest in vinyl was rooted in its usages for the body, like chairs in a home, clothes, booths in a public indoor space, and in the bedroom. It was probably the reference to the bedroom that peaked my interests the most. The bedroom is a place of sex, dreams, sleep, sickness, death, waking up, reading, praying, meditating, putting on clothes needed to walk through a door—a portal."

Watch Curator Michelle Kuo share her impressions of McMillian's "shape-shifting" work.

Portal into another world | Rodney McMillian's "Succulent" (2010) | UNIQ
The Museum of Modern Art

Watch on

Anicka Yi, *Shameplex*, 2015

Anicka Yi. *Shameplex*. 2015. Plexiglass, nickel-plated straight pins, ultrasonic gel, and LED strips, seven boxes, each box 24 × 48 × 24" (61 × 121.9 × 61 cm), overall dimensions variable. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. Installation view, *7,070,430K of Digital Spit*, Kunsthalle Basel, 2015. Photo: Philipp Hänger/Kunsthalle Basel

Anicka Yi's *Shameplex* features seven rectangular Plexiglas boxes filled with a shallow layer of ultrasonic gel, typically used during medical ultrasounds. Nickel-plated straight pins sit suspended within the gel in various geometric patterns. As time goes on, the pins begin to corrode, progressively generating a red, rusting pattern. Like so much of Yi's work, *Shameplex* reveals the messy, if surprisingly beautiful, edges of technology and biology—the algorithms that drive the cycles of our life and sensory perceptions. As Yi says, "I think that the role of the artist is really, quite frankly, as much as a scientist, to define what life is and what life can be."

Mark as completed

Like Dislike Report an issue